

### Overview & Framework

At Asbury Theological Seminary (ATS), we are more than just co-workers; we are a people called to a higher purpose. We are co-laborers with Christ, each endowed with immense value and unique purpose. Together, we play a crucial role in building a community called to prepare theologically educated, sanctified, Spirit-filled men and women to evangelize and to spread scriptural holiness throughout the world through the love of Jesus Christ, in the power of the Holy Spirit and to the glory of God the Father.

Building on the FLOURISH framework developed by Best Christian Workplaces, we strive to create a culture where our teams excel, work is life-giving, talent is outstanding, growth and development are uplifting, compensation is rewarding, leadership is inspirational, strategies are sustainable, and communication is healthy. When these elements are in place, ATS is better positioned to accomplish its mission.

This document focuses on *Rewarding Compensation*, one of the eight FLOURISH factors. Flourishing cultures provide tangible remuneration and benefits for an employee's service, reinforcing the idea that their contributions are valued. The components of *Rewarding Compensation* include pay, health plan, retirement plan, vacation and time off, flexible work arrangements, recognition, and tuition remission. Though compensation includes both pay and benefits, this document serves as a strategic framework to detail the guiding principles and beliefs that inform how ATS will structure and manage employee pay.

The following questions will serve as the foundation of the Seminary's compensation philosophy:

1. How will the Seminary pursue external equity?
2. How will the Seminary pursue internal equity?
3. How will the Seminary reward service and performance?

### 1. External Equity

External equity emphasizes fair compensation for employees in comparison to their peers outside the organization. To maintain external equity, ATS will regularly benchmark positions to assess and align with market values for each role.

- **Industry and Position Specific:** We begin by comparing ourselves to similar organizations, such as higher education institutions of similar size. However, to obtain accurate comparisons, we may choose to look beyond this group
- **Location:** Recognizing that we compete for talent in different regions, we will compare positions to the local market, regional market, or even national market.

- **Target:** Our current goal is to benchmark pay at the median rate for each position.

## **2. Internal Equity**

Internal equity focuses on fair compensation for employees in comparison to others within the organization.

- **Pay Ranges:** Pay ranges will be established based on market comparisons for roles of similar size and responsibility.
- **Range Placement:** Placement within a range occurs initially at the time of hire, with adjustments made based on performance and experience.

## **3. Service and Performance Increases**

Service and performance increases reflect ATS's commitment to honoring both the dedication and achievements of our employees, fostering a culture of appreciation and growth.

- **Service Pay Increases:** Base pay increases to acknowledge length of service, regardless of performance.
- **Performance Pay Increases:** Pay increases to recognize accomplishments and the quality of work.